

Joel Watlington

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Current Address : Manchester, NH

Online Portfolio : joelwatlington.com

QUALIFICATIONS

Achievements

- Top-secret Clearance with SCI eligibility (2021) (exp. Aug. 2026)
- CompTIA Security+ Certification (2025) (exp. Jan. 2028)
- CompTIA Server+ Certification (2025) (Good For Life)
- Given formal congratulations after presenting the first automated test case under NG (2025)
- Nominated for a CARES award at the State of Maine (2023)

Techniques

- Highly technical knowledge through **Cloud**, **DevOps**, **Web Development** and **Automation**
- Leadership and communication experience using **agile methodology** and **Jira** through user stories, tickets, and Kanban boards
- Documentation skills through numerous **Confluence** pages including complete coverage of Eggplant automation, Ansible playbooks, and missile defense software for onsite servers

Software

- **AWS Cloud** – Architected secure cloud infrastructure utilizing IAM roles, Route 53 DNS routing, and security groups; Engineered automated AMI pipelines, deployed Lambda functions, and managed company wide operations through the AWS console
- **Docker** – Utilized docker commands to streamline programming functionality under Wright Patterson AFB and FBI to improve deployment flow, programming control, and a baseline for all operations
- **Gitlab CI/CD**, **Gitlab runners**, and **YAML** – Deployed Gitlab runners that executed jobs to create service containers, security tests, and unit tests for pushing data into Jfrog while working under Wright Patterson AFB and FBI
- **Jenkins** – Crafted a large software feature under Northrop Grumman to scan every new file that had been pushed for vulnerabilities using Coverity. Additionally supported new pipeline functionality for automation while communicating 24/7 automation to the information systems security manager
- **Ansible** – Guided Ansible playbooks under FBI to dynamically allocate user accounts, streamline patching while also displaying critical version information, and organized health status scripts to replace Puppet licensing through the creation of systemd jobs
- **Kubernetes** – Delegated a Kubernetes clusters, nodes, and pods to allow for scalability in resources for Docker containers and software while working under Wright Patterson AFB; engineered scalable microservices architectures, managed pod deployments, and configured cluster ingress controllers

- **Terraform** – Designed a completely new terraform structure under FBI so that AWS console implementation would not only be consistent but more secure through the alteration of security groups
- **Kafka** and **Zookeeper** – Deployed multi-node message brokers and managed Zookeeper states to ensure seamless cluster coordination, topic creation, and fault-tolerant data streaming under FBI
- **Python** – Built multiple scripts i.e. manipulating **JSON** and **NDJSON** files under the Elasticsearch team. Supported python scripting to aid in automating eggplant by generating log files. Created post test analysis to concisely track the automation flow throughout the time supporting Northrop Grumman
- **Git** and **Bitbucket** – Organized, deployed, and collaborated with multiple different teams across many different repositories through all past work experiences
- **Linux/Bash** – Actively programmed using bash scripting to automate complex data ingestion pipelines; highly familiar with the Linux operating system to support team development, manage user accounts, and execute system commands including curl, dnf, and scp while working for Northrop Grumman and the FBI
- **Rocky Linux Distribution** – Acutely created CRON jobs and managed file permissions under Wright Patterson AFB
- **Angular** – reliably worked tickets under a large team with the federal government developing a full-stack application to meet expectations of multiple product owners
- **JavaScript** – Manipulated JavaScript for various data changes in the federal government and the CDC
- **Java** – Successfully crafted back-end functionality for API calls using Java while working for the federal government
- **C#** – Utilized **ASP.NET** and **ASP Classic** framework to maintain programs using C# and have a strong grasp of the language throughout working with the State of Maine
- **C++** – Under Wright Patterson Cpp files were used for version control and mathematical programming so that unit testing functioned properly
- **Eggplant** – Established test cases, scripts, and drivers under Northrop Grumman through eggplant coding to allow automated flow through product lines
- **SQL Developer**, **PostgreSQL**, and **SQL Server Management Studio** – Has no problem fixing database related issues or mapping large database tables for programming new functionality
- **Postman** – Resourcefully used postman for testing and debugging website API calls throughout my experience as a web developer
- **React.js**, **Next.js**, and **Tailwind** – easily created my portfolio using powerful react customization
- **Kibana**, **EQL**, and **Lucene** – Competently developed tickets through the Elasticsearch team by organizing data and creating install packages

WORK EXPERIENCE

FBI – **Mid-Level Cloud Developer** | Huntsville, AL

(Mar. 2026 – May 2026)

- Engineered an automated Gitlab CI/CD pipeline using Docker-in-Docker to dynamically build Amazon machine images for Ansible deployments
- Refactored and modularized Terraform to optimize readability and scalability for cloud security groups while also hardening cloud security by changing CIDR-based rules into strict role-based rules
- Streamlined patch management, user provisioning, and health monitoring by designing multiple Ansible playbooks; successfully eliminating Puppet license requirements to generate significant cost savings
- Deployed and optimized Apache Kafka clusters within AWS, configuring underlying Zookeeper dependencies, and automated topic creation to facilitate high-throughput real-time data streaming
- Utilized curl commands to troubleshoot network connectivity, test REST API endpoints, and automate data retrieval from remote servers. Managed system packages, dependencies, and security patches across Linux environments using dnf package management tools

Northrop Grumman – **Automation Engineer Lead** | Huntsville, AL

(Sept. 2024 – Feb. 2026)

- Developed and optimized DevOps pipelines through Jenkins to ultimately enhance deployment speed and improve project delivery timelines
- Employed automation software using Eggplant and Python so that test cases and post-test analysis would be generated without any manual intervention
- Orchestrated presentation skills through creating videos to demonstrate competence for government customers. Teaching experience by instructing an entire team how to use Eggplant software for aiding automation efforts
- Assisted Coworkers, Scrum Master, Product Owner, and Technical Lead by creating Jira stories, providing feedback, and aiding in work management as a professional team leader that changed company flow
- Hands-on experience working with the integration team to produce Ansible playbooks that facilitated software installation through automated means
- Administered user accounts, managed groups, and configured granular sudo privileges to maintain strict access control environments
- Designed and deployed multiple robust Bash scripts to automate complex data ingestion pipelines, reducing manual processing time

Wright Patterson AFB – **DevOps Engineer** | Dayton, OH

(Mar. 2024 – Aug. 2024)

- Engineered a streamlined GitLab pipeline that reduced deployment time by leveraging Docker for secure service container integration
- Optimized Docker container images by minimizing package dependencies and debugging any issues using the Linux terminal, successfully reducing image footprint and accelerating cluster pull times
- Streamlined application deployment on Kubernetes clusters by designing and managing dynamic Helm charts. Integrated Helm chart deployments into an automated CI/CD pipeline using GitLab
- Consistently navigating Jfrog artifactory to solve dependency issues for key libraries and programming Cpp / Hpp files to allow correct mathematical flow

State of Maine – **Software Engineer** | Augusta, ME

(Jun. 2023 – Nov. 2023)

- Enhanced client satisfaction by maintaining web applications, resolving bugs, and implementing features to ensure timely communication of expectations
- Frequently monitoring emails to aid clients regarding software installations, database fixes, or general usage in a timely, polite, and intelligent way
- Succinctly learning cybersecurity and programming techniques throughout over 40 hours of professional training
- Maintained and optimized multiple database platforms, including MySQL and SQL Server, enhancing application performance and reliability

Robins Air Force Base – **Elasticsearch Engineer** | Warner Robins, GA

(July 2021 – Mar. 2023)

- Assembled custom Elastic Integration Packages that improved data accuracy through effective parsing and optimization techniques
- Navigated Linux administration commands to troubleshoot Elasticsearch problems and aid efficient communication flow
- Architected Logstash data pipelines to ingest, prune, and normalize high-volume datasets for accuracy and clean data delivery
- Developed interactive Kibana dashboards and deployed Machine Learning to transform raw log data into insightful analysis
- Worked a full-stack application using Angular and Spring Boot, enabling efficient data management for government projects across the country
- Manipulated machine learning techniques to aid in anomaly searches within large company wide datasets

EDUCATION

Tennessee Technological University – Cookeville, TN

(May 2021)

- Bachelor of Science in Computer Science
- Cumulative GPA: 3.54 Graduated with Cum Laude

Motlow State Community College – Tullahoma, TN

(May 2018)

- Associates of Science in Chemistry
- GPA: 3.94